

τὰ ἄδεσποτα λυρικά

Lyric Poetry Anonymous on Cyprus and the Gods

eul_aid: dgq

Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Μικταὶ διάλεκτοι* [Mixed Dialects](#) (frg)
Domain: *Ποίησις* [Poetry](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Lyric Poetry Anonymous is a collective designation for unattributed lyric poems from the Archaic and Classical periods of Greece, spanning the seventh to fifth centuries BCE. These poems originated across the Greek world and were performed in varied social contexts, including public choral events for religious festivals and private monodic song at symposia. Their transmission is almost entirely fragmentary, relying on quotations in later authors, papyrus finds, and inscriptions.

The corpus consists of numerous unattributed lyric fragments, categorized by scholars as adespota. Major collections appear in the *Poetae Melici Graeci* and *Supplementum Lyricis Graecis*. Specific examples include the Linos-song fragment and various paeans preserved on inscriptions from sites like Delphi. All works in this category are fragmentary.

This anonymous corpus provides a broader view of Greek lyric poetry beyond the canonical named poets, revealing the widespread practice of lyric composition for ritual and entertainment. The fragments are crucial evidence for reconstructing musical culture, dialectal diversity, and performance practices, highlighting the fragmentary nature of literary transmission.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Κύπρου καὶ Θεῶν](#) · [Fragments on Cyprus and the Gods](#) · 281 passages